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Laminate, adhesive kit, laminated structure and production method thereof, and contact adhesive composition

Abstract

A laminate comprising a substrate layer; a contact adhesive layer comprising a contact adhesive agent having at least one of chloroprene rubber or acrylic copolymers, as well as microspheres having an average particle size of 0.5 μm or greater in the contact adhesive layer, wherein the contact adhesive layer contains from 5 parts by mass to 500 parts by mass of the microspheres per 100 parts by mass of the contact adhesive agent, and the contact adhesive layer has a plurality of protruding portions because of the the microspheres.

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Background/Summary

(1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/780,312, filed May 31, 2018, now, abandoned.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates to a laminate having a contact adhesive layer, an adhesive kit, a laminated structure, a production method of such a laminated structure, and a contact adhesive composition.

BACKGROUND ART

(2) Decorative sheets are used for decorating interior or exterior walls, furniture or automobiles. These decorative sheets typically have pressure-sensitive adhesive layer on a back surface and they are applied to the adhered via the pressure sensitive adhesive layers. It is often difficult to apply the decorative sheet on an accurate position because of tackiness of the pressure sensitive adhesive layer. Therefore, it has been developed technology of controlling the tackiness of the pressure sensitive adhesive layer.

(3) U.S. Pat. No. 5,008,139 describes “A pressure-sensitive adhesive layer having, on at least one surface thereof, a layer of evenly dispersed non-adhesive solid particles having an average particle diameter of 10 to 60 microns, wherein at least about half of the solid particles project from the surface of the adhesive layer to a height corresponding to at least about one-fourth of the average particle diameter of the solid particles, and if the solid particles are hollow particles, the walls of the hollow particles are not rupturable by the pressure of bonding. The pressure-sensitive adhesive layer has a very low initial adhesion strength (adhesion strength before press-bonding). After press-bonding, it rapidly develops adhesion strength, and attains a very high final adhesion strength”

(4) U.S. Pat. No. 5,795,636 describes “An adhesive sheet having an adhesive layer and at least one surface being topologically microstructured, either with configured structures or a coating of particles and an underlying adhesive such that the adhesive layer has at least two levels of adhesion, a contact bond and an application bond, such that initial contact bond is substantially less

than the application bond and that the contact bond simultaneously changes to the application bond with the application of pressure onto the adhesive sheet.”

(5) Contact adhesives are well known for bonding various components or members. JP4049450B describes “an aqueous contact adhesive formed by heat-melting, in the presence of an alkaline substance, a low acid-value tackifier resin that is solid at room temperature and that has a softening point of 100° C. or lower, in a liquid containing a chloroprene rubber latex obtained by copolymerizing an ethylene-based unsaturated carboxylic acid that is copolymerizable with chloroprene and chloroprene in the presence of polyvinyl alcohol, or a chloroprene rubber latex obtained by copolymerizing an ethylene-based unsaturated carboxylic acid that is copolymerizable with chloroprene and chloroprene in the presence of polyvinyl alcohol and glycol ethers”.

SUMMARY OF INVENTION

(6) An adhesive-backed laminate construction that provides good repositionability before final setting has been discovered. The adhesive layer is a contact adhesive containing a plurality of beads. The shape and sizing of the beads, and the ratio of beads to contact adhesive, is selected such that the presence of the beads in the adhesive layer effects a plurality of protrusions from the adhesive layer. The protrusions prevent aggressive bonding of between the adhesive layer and an installation substrate, and allow the adhesive-backed laminate construction to slide over an installation surface, effecting good repositionability during the installation process. Once positioning of the adhesive-backed laminate is satisfactory, the position may be finally set by pressing the adhesive-backed laminate against the installation surface.

(7) Decorative adhesive-backed films have typically required the use of a release liner. The release liner protects the adhesive layer during manufacturing and transport, and is removed at the time of installation, revealing the adhesive surface of the adhesive-backed laminate. It is later discarded. Besides being wasteful, the presence a release liner can introduce difficulties into the application process, particularly for large sheets of decorative film, for which the liner removal may be complicated and give rise to wrinkles in the installed laminate.

(8) The present disclosure provides a contact adhesive-backed laminate construction having a low tack adhesive surface that may preclude, in some embodiments, the need for a traditional liner. The low tack adhesive surface may exhibit good slidability and repositionability during application. Upon further pressing of the adhesive securely bonds to the application substrate. Adhesive kit embodiments are also described, which additionally involve the use of a primer adhesive layer applied to the installation substrate before installation of the adhesive-backed laminate.

(9) In one embodiment, is a laminate construction is described, comprising a substrate layer; a contact adhesive layer containing a contact adhesive agent containing at least one of chloroprene rubber or acrylic copolymers, and microspheres having an average particle size of 0.5 μm or greater in the contact adhesive layer, wherein the contact adhesive layer contains from 5 parts by mass to 500 parts by mass of the microspheres per 100 parts by mass of the contact adhesive agent, and wherein the contact adhesive layer has a plurality of protruding microsphere portions.

(10) Another embodiment described herein concerns a film-based article comprising the laminate recited above and a primer agent containing a second contact adhesive agent containing at least one of chloroprene rubber or acrylic copolymers.

(11) Yet another embodiment described herein concerns a method of applying a laminated structure to an installation surface, the method comprising preparing the laminate described above; applying a primer agent containing a second contact adhesive agent containing at least one of chloroprene rubber or acrylic copolymers on a installation surface so as to form a second contact adhesive layer, and placing the laminate on the second contact adhesive layer, and then pressing (and thereby adhering) the contact adhesive layer of the laminate to the second contact adhesive layer.

(12) Yet another embodiment described herein concerns a laminated structure formed on a base material to be adhered comprising the laminate recited above, and a second contact adhesive layer covered on the installation surface, wherein both of the contact adhesive layer of the laminate and

the second contact adhesive layer are adhered to each other, the second contact adhesive layer containing a second contact adhesive agent containing at least one of chloroprene rubber or acrylic copolymers.

(13) Yet another embodiment described herein concerns a contact adhesive composition comprising a contact adhesive agent containing at least one of chloroprene rubber or acrylic copolymers, and microspheres having an average particle size of 0.5 μm or greater, and further comprising from 5 parts by mass to 500 parts by mass of the organic resin microspheres per 100 parts by mass of the contact adhesive agent.

(14) Since the laminate of the present invention uses, in some embodiments, a low tack contact adhesive layer surface, a protective liner may not be necessary. When a protective liner is not used, the laminate of the present disclosure can be produced, stored, and transported as a continuous roll of film, or as a stack of a film sheets. This eliminates waste and money associated with the use of liners. Furthermore, in some embodiments the surface of the adhesive layer of the laminate of the present disclosure provides good slidability, positioning, and repositioning. After positioning or repositioning the laminate on an installation substrate (such as a wall or other installation surface), the laminate may be adhesively set pressing, with a roller or one's hand, the laminate onto the installation substrate.

(15) The adhesive kit of the present disclosure contains the laminate as described above, and additionally includes a primer agent that is suitable for the contact adhesion of the laminate, thus providing good slidability and better contact adhesion of the laminate upon installation. The primer is applied to the installation surface before the laminate.

(16) The contact adhesive composition of the present disclosure can be suitably used in the production of the laminate described above.

(17) Note that the above description should not be construed to be a disclosure of all of the embodiments and benefits of the present invention.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a cross sectional view of a laminate of an embodiment of the present invention.

(2) FIG. 2 is a drawing for explaining the method of producing a laminated structure of an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(3) FIG. 3 is a cross sectional view of a laminated structure.

(4) FIGS. 4A and 4B are for explaining the method of installing flooring panels using a laminated structure of an embodiment of the present disclosure.

DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

(5) A detailed description for the purpose of illustrating representative embodiments of the present invention is given below. These embodiments should not be construed as limiting the present invention.

(6) The laminate of an embodiment of the present disclosure comprises a substrate layer; a contact adhesive layer comprising a contact adhesive agent containing at least one of chloroprene rubber or acrylic copolymers, and microspheres having an average particle size of 0.5 μm or greater in the contact adhesive layer, wherein the contact adhesive layer contains from 5 parts by mass to 500 parts by mass of the microspheres per 100 parts by mass of the contact adhesive agent. The contact adhesive layer has a plurality of protrusions from its surface, effected by the presence of the microspheres in the adhesive layer.

(7) In this disclosure, "contact adhesive" refers to an adhesive which is typically applied to two surfaces to be adhered together, dried to form film adhesive layers, and brought into contact with pressure so as to form an immediate, durable bond.

(8) In the disclosure “microspheres” refers to particles having diameters than several micrometers. In some preferred embodiments, they are sustainably spherical. Substantially spherical means having a cross-sectional shape corresponding to that of a circle or an ellipse, or having a spherical surface.

(9) The laminate of an embodiment of the present disclosure is illustrated as a cross sectional view in FIG. 1. The laminate **10** illustrated in FIG. 1 has a substrate layer **12** and a contact adhesive layer **14**, and the contact adhesive layer **14** has a contact adhesive agent **16** and organic resin microspheres **18**. In FIG. 1, the microspheres **18** are illustrated as being completely covered by the contact adhesive agent **16**; however, a part of the microspheres **18** may be exposed to the outside. Furthermore, in FIG. 1, the microspheres **18** are illustrated as separate particles arranged regularly; however, a plurality of the microspheres **18** may be agglomerated, or a single or a plurality of agglomerated microspheres **18** may be arranged irregularly on the surface of the contact adhesive layer. There are a plurality of protruding portions because of the existing of the microspheres on a surface of the laminate **10**.

(10) The substrate layer may be selected from various materials and articles depending on the purpose thereof. Examples of the substrate layer include paper, transparent films, decorative films, decorative plates, wallpaper, flooring materials, metal plates, woven fabric, nonwoven fabric, foam, and the like. The substrate layer may be a laminate composed of a plurality of layers. The substrate layer may also be a part of an article having a substrate layer, such as a part of a decorative sheet. For example, each of the substrate layer and the adherend may be a part of one article, such as a flap and a corresponding surface of an envelope. The substrate layer may have undergone surface treatment, such as primer treatment or corona treatment, on a bonding face for the contact adhesive layer.

(11) The contact adhesive layer may have a plurality of protruding portions and a surface that is substantially nontacky at operating temperature (typically room temperature). “Substantially nontacky at room temperature” refers to a condition where an adherend can be removed with no or substantially no resistance that can be felt by hands after the adherend was pressed lightly on the surface of the contact adhesive layer at 23° C.±0.5° C. In this condition, if the contact adhesive is lightly pressed onto an installation surface directly, as would occur during initial positioning of a laminate during an installation, the contact adhesive does not adhere to the installation surface at all, or if there is adhesion it is very light and easily succumbs to an installer's further maneuvering.

(12) A plurality of protruding portions of the contact adhesive layer formed due to the microspheres **18** makes the surface of the contact adhesive layer rough. The degree of the surface roughness of the contact adhesive layer can be evaluated by, for example, a 60 degree gloss value. In some embodiments, the 60 degree gloss value of the contact adhesive layer surface is approximately 1 or greater, approximately 2 or greater, or approximately 3 or greater, but approximately 40 or less, approximately 35 or less, or approximately 30 or less, when measured in accordance with Japanese Industrial Standard Z8741 or ISO 2813.

(13) A part of the contact adhesive layer that interfaces with the installation surface may be covered by another material, such as printing ink or metal thin film, so long as it does not unduly interfere with the performance of the contact adhesive. In one embodiment, the contact adhesive layer also serves as a receiving layer of printing ink, such as ink for inkjet printing. Although in one embodiment the laminate of the present disclosure does not require a liner, a liner may be arranged on the contact adhesive layer surface. In such an embodiment, the contact adhesive layer surface can be protected from oils and fats, dust, or the like when the laminate is used as an intermediate product and is subjected to further processing or treatment.

(14) The contact adhesive agent is a component serving as a base of the contact adhesive layer. The contact adhesive agent adheres to itself or to a chemically similar material by applying pressure without a significant increase in temperature (e.g. without requiring a temperature higher than 50° C.). Therefore, unlike pressure-sensitive adhesive agent, the contact adhesive agent does not adhere

to a chemically different material or shows little adhesive force to such a material, typically, at a temperature of approximately 10° C. to approximately 50° C. On the other hand, the pressure-sensitive adhesive agents show tackiness at room temperature (23±0.5° C.) and adhere to different types of materials by applying appropriate pressure (pressure applied by a finger, or the like).

(15) The contact adhesive agent contains at least one of chloroprene rubber or acrylic copolymers as an adhesive component.

(16) The chloroprene rubber (CR) may be a homopolymer or copolymer of chloroprene (2-chloro-1,3-butadiene). Typically, a highly crystalline chloroprene rubber is used due to its excellent contact adhesion. Chloroprene rubber can be obtained by polymerizing chloroprene and, optionally, a copolymerizable monomer by solution polymerization, emulsion polymerization, suspension polymerization, or the like. Examples of the copolymerizable monomer for chloroprene rubber include vinyl-based unsaturated monomers such as styrene, vinyltoluene, 2,3-dichlorobutadiene, acrylic acid, methacrylic acid, methacrylates, acrylates, acrylonitrile, vinyl acetate, and polyvinyl alcohol. Chloroprene rubber may be crosslinked due to the double bond present in chloroprene rubber and a reaction caused by a crosslinking agent.

(17) An acrylic copolymer can be obtained by copolymerizing alkyl acrylates having an alkyl group having from 1 to 8 carbons, alkoxy ethyl acrylates having an alkoxy group having from 1 to 4 carbons, acrylic acid, hydroxy group-containing acrylates, such as 2-hydroxyethyl acrylate, acrylic monomers, such as acrylamide, styrene, vinyltoluene, alkyl methacrylates having an alkyl group having from 1 to 8 carbons, such as methyl methacrylate and ethyl methacrylate, methacrylic acid, hydroxy group-containing methacrylates, such as 2-hydroxyethyl methacrylate, and other vinyl-based unsaturated monomers, such as methacrylamide, maleic acid, and itaconic acid, by solution polymerization, emulsion polymerization, suspension polymerization, or the like. Examples of the alkyl acrylate having an alkyl group having from 1 to 8 carbons include methyl acrylate, ethyl acrylate, n-butyl acrylate, 2-ethylhexyl acrylate, and the like. Examples of alkoxy ethyl acrylate having an alkyl group having from 1 to 4 carbons include 2-methoxyethyl acrylate, 2-ethoxyethyl acrylate, 2-butoxyethyl acrylate, and the like. Among these, use of an acrylic copolymer containing a polymerization unit derived from alkyl acrylate having an alkyl group having from 2 to 4 carbons, such as ethyl acrylate or n-butyl acrylate, as a main component at an amount of, for example, greater than approximately 50% by mass, approximately 70% by mass or greater, or approximately 80% by mass or greater achieves excellent balance of nontackiness and contact adhesion. The acrylic copolymer may be crosslinked.

(18) The glass transition temperature of the acrylic contact adhesive is preferably approximately 0° C. or higher, approximately 10° C. or higher, or approximately 20° C. or higher, but approximately 60° C. or lower, approximately 50° C. or lower, or approximately 40° C. or lower. By setting the glass transition temperature (T_g) of the acrylic contact adhesive to be within the range described above, excellent balance of nontackiness and contact adhesion of the contact adhesive agent can be achieved. If the T_g is low, the tackiness may become stronger and blocking resistance may be lowered. Meanwhile, the T_g is high, adhesiveness of the contact adhesive may be lowered. Unless indicated otherwise, all T_g values referenced herein are measured according to ASTM D4092-07.

(19) The contact adhesive agent may contain additional polymer components. Examples of the additional polymer component include natural rubber, polybutadiene, polyisoprene, ethylene-vinyl acetate copolymers, polyvinyl acetate, polyvinyl acetate copolymers, styrene-butadiene copolymers, styrene-isoprene copolymers, butadiene-acrylonitrile copolymers, polyurethane, polyvinylidene chloride, and the like, and combinations of these. In some embodiments, the additional polymer component is contained in the contact adhesive agent at an amount of approximately 5% by mass or greater, approximately 10% by mass or greater, or approximately 15% by mass or greater, but approximately 60% by mass or less, approximately 50% by mass or less, or approximately 40% by mass or less, in terms of solid content of the contact adhesive agent.

(20) The contact adhesive agent may contain a tackifier. As the tackifier, rosin derivatives, such as

polymerized rosin and hydrogenated rosin, terpene-modified products, such as terpene resins and terpene phenol resins, coumarone-indene resins, aliphatic hydrocarbon resins, aromatic petroleum resins, phenol-based resins, styrene-based resins, xylene resins, and the like can be used. In some embodiments, the tackifier is contained in the contact adhesive agent at an amount of approximately 1% by mass or greater, approximately 2% by mass or greater, or approximately 5% by mass or greater, but approximately 50% by mass or less, approximately 30% by mass or less, or approximately 20% by mass or less, in terms of solid content of the contact adhesive agent.

(21) The contact adhesive agent may further contain, as an optional component, an emulsifier, surfactant, and/or pH adjusting agent that are(is) used for emulsion polymerization or suspension polymerization of the adhesive component, a plasticizer, an antioxidant, a viscosity adjusting agent, a surfactant, a humectant, a UV absorbing agent, a photostabilizer, a pigment, a biocide, a preservative, a corrosion inhibitor, an inorganic filler, or the like. The contact adhesive can be cross-linked.

(22) The microspheres have an average particle size of approximately 0.5 μm or greater. The average particle size of the microspheres is defined as a volume average particle size (D_v) that can be measured by a laser diffraction scattering type particle size distribution analyzer.

(23) By allowing the microspheres having an average particle size of approximately 0.5 μm or greater, a plurality of adhesive protrusions extend outward from the adhesive layer surface, thereby raising the adhesive layer surface somewhat, keeping it from making intimate contact with an installation surface (except in the presence of intentional pressure), and thereby making the surface substantially nontacky. The plurality of the microspheres may be agglomerated in the contact adhesive layer. Such an agglomerate of the microspheres advantageously can contribute to formation of the protruding portions of the contact adhesive layer surface.

(24) In some embodiments, the average particle size of the microspheres is approximately 0.3 nm or greater, approximately 0.5 nm or greater, or approximately 0.7 nm or greater, but approximately 100 nm or less, approximately 70 nm or less, or approximately 50 nm or less. If the average particle size is less than 0.3 nm, it may be difficult to form the protruding portions based on the existing of the microspheres on the contact adhesive layer surface. If the average particle size is greater than 100 nm, the protruding portions be unsuitably rough and thus be noticeable on final application.

(25) In some embodiments, the microspheres are preferably an organic resin. As the organic resin particles are relatively light compared to inorganic particles, the organic resin microspheres tend not to settle and can keep good dispersibility, when they are mixed with the contact adhesive. Eventually, the microspheres can be dispersed more uniformly in the contact adhesive layer.

(26) In some embodiments, specific gravity of the microspheres for the contact adhesive is approximately 0.9 or greater, approximately 1.0 or greater, or approximately 1.05 or greater, but approximately 1.50 or less, approximately 1.40 or less, or approximately 1.35 or less. By selecting the density of the microspheres to be within the range described above, slidability characteristics can be more uniformly imparted to the entire surface of the contact adhesive layer, by preventing extremely uneven distribution (e.g., precipitation) of the microspheres in the contact adhesive layer during the formation of the contact adhesive layer.

(27) In some embodiments, the microspheres are nontacky. The nontackiness refers to a condition where microspheres have flowability at the operation temperature, typically at room temperature ($23^\circ\text{C} \pm 0.5^\circ\text{C}$). If nontacky microspheres are used, microspheres can obtain the flowability among microspheres, slidability features can be more uniformly imparted to the entire surface of the contact adhesive layer by preventing extremely uneven distribution (e.g., precipitation) of the microspheres in the contact adhesive layer during the formation of the contact adhesive layer.

(28) The microspheres may contain a polymer, such as an acrylic polymer (e.g. homopolymers and copolymers of alkyl acrylates such as polymethyl methacrylate and n-butyl acrylate, or the like), polycarbonate, polyurethane, polyester, and polystyrene. These polymers may be crosslinked. The

microspheres are preferably acrylic polymers, which show suitable dispersibility in the contact adhesive agent. Since the microspheres of crosslinked acrylic polymer are unlikely to be deformed due to its high hardness, the microspheres can impart even higher slidability to the contact adhesive layer. Further, it is preferably used crosslinked polymer for micorshere as to obtain solvent resistance and stable high elasticity for large temperature range.

(29) The microspheres may be solid microspheres or hollow microspheres. As hollow microspheres, shell and core type particle can be used. For example, microspheres having the shell part made of urethane resin and the core part made of acrylic resin can be used. The microspheres can be colored by pigments or dye. Microspheres are preferably solid ones. Solid microspheres, typically more unlikely to be deformed under load, may impart even higher slidability characteristics to the contact adhesive layer. The microspheres are preferably acrylic polymers, particularly preferably solid microspheres of crosslinked acrylic polymer, due to the high hardness and a good load bearing when being rolled up.

(30) The shape of the microspheres is, in one embodiment, substantially spherical or spherical. By using substantially spherical or spherical microspheres, as compared with non-spherical shapes, slidability of the contact adhesive layer can be further enhanced.

(31) The microspheres preferably have high elasticity and are hard to deform. In some embodiments, the elastic modulus of the microspheres is approximately 2×10^{10} Pa or greater, approximately 5×10^{10} Pa or greater, or approximately 1×10^{11} Pa or greater; but approximately 5×10^{11} Pa or less, approximately 1×10^{12} Pa or less, or approximately 5×10^{12} Pa or less.

(32) The microspheres are contained in the contact adhesive layer at ratio of approximately 5 parts by mass to approximately 500 parts by mass per 100 parts by mass of the contact adhesive agent. In some embodiments, the microspheres are contained in the contact adhesive layer at a ratio of approximately 2 parts by mass or greater, approximately 5 parts by mass or greater, or approximately 8 parts by mass or greater; but approximately 550 parts by mass or less, approximately 500 parts by mass or less, or approximately 450 parts by mass or less, per 100 parts by mass of the contact adhesive agent. By setting the compounded amount of the microspheres to be within the range described above, a plurality of protruding portions are formed on the contact adhesive layer surface. When positioned by an installer against an installation substrate, a laminate having a contact adhesive with a plurality of protruding portions (formed as described above) makes the surface of the contact adhesive layer substantially nontacky at room temperature, and provides good slidability during application of the laminate. In some embodiments, the laminate does not require a protective liner.

(33) A contact adhesive layer can be formed by using a contact adhesive composition comprising a contact adhesive agent containing at least one of chloroprene rubber or acrylic copolymers, and nontacky microspheres having an average particle size of approximately $0.5 \mu\text{m}$ or greater, and containing from approximately 5 parts by mass to approximately 500 parts by mass of the microspheres per 100 parts by mass of the contact adhesive agent. The components and the amounts contained in the contact adhesive composition are as described above for the contact adhesive layer.

(34) The contact adhesive composition can be prepared by mixing the microspheres into a solvent system, emulsion system, or solventless system composition containing at least one of chloroprene rubber or acrylic copolymers as an adhesive component, and other optional components, such as an additional polymer component, a tackifier, a plasticizer, and the like. Examples of the solvent system composition include organic solvents such as methanol, ethanol, hexane, toluene, acetone, methyl ethyl ketone, and ethyl acetate, and combinations of these.

(35) From the perspectives of requiring no organic solvent treatment during the production step of the laminate and achieving excellent coatability, it is advantageous for the contact adhesive composition to be an aqueous emulsion.

(36) When the contact adhesive composition is a solvent system or an emulsion system, the solid content thereof can be set to, for example, approximately 20% by mass or greater, approximately 30% by mass or greater, or approximately 40% by mass or greater; but approximately 80% by mass or less, approximately 70% by mass or less, or approximately 60% by mass or less. By setting the solid content to be within the range described above, a composition having good coatability and drying property can be obtained.

(37) The laminate of the present disclosure can be produced by applying the contact adhesive composition on a surface of a substrate layer and, as necessary, drying or curing it to form a contact adhesive layer on the substrate layer. The application of the contact adhesive composition onto the substrate layer surface can be performed using, for example, knife coating, bar coating, blade coating, doctor coating, roll coating, cast coating, spraying, screen printing, stencil printing, brush coating, or the like. The application conditions of the contact adhesive composition, such as coating speed, application temperature, coating thickness (wet thickness), and drying or curing conditions including for example drying or curing temperature, can be selected in a manner that the protruding portions are formed with sufficient density on the contact adhesive layer surface.

(38) The contact adhesive composition is preferably applied on the substrate layer surface in a manner that the mass per unit area of the contact adhesive layer is approximately 5 g/m.² or greater, approximately 10 g/m.² or greater, or approximately 15 g/m.² or greater; but approximately 100 g/m.² or less, approximately 80 g/m.² or less, or approximately 60 g/m.² or less. By setting the mass per unit area of the contact adhesive layer to be within the range described above, the protruding portions can be formed on the entire surface of the contact adhesive layer with sufficient density and in-plane uniformity of the slidability can be enhanced.

(39) The thickness of the contact adhesive layer can be set typically to approximately 5 μm or greater, approximately 10 μm or greater, or approximately 15 μm or greater; but approximately 100 μm or less, approximately 80 μm or less, or approximately 60 μm or less. By setting the thickness of the contact adhesive layer to be within the range described above, the protruding portions can be formed on the contact adhesive layer surface in a manner such that the microspheres are not completely embedded in the contact adhesive layer and protrude somewhat from, or sit proud of, the contact adhesive layer.

(40) In another embodiment of the present disclosure, a kit which is a combination of the laminate described above and a primer agent is provided. The kit could be sold to a customer. The primer agent is used to form a second contact adhesive layer on the installation surface and contains a second contact adhesive agent containing at least one of chloroprene rubber or acrylic copolymers, and optionally, nontacky second microspheres having an average particle size of approximately 0.5 μm or greater. In the primer layer, the microspheres are an optional component, and the components and the amounts of the microspheres contained in the primer agent are the same as those described for the contact adhesive composition.

(41) The second contact adhesive agent and/or the second microspheres, which are an optional component, contained in the primer agent may be the same as or different from the contact adhesive agent (first contact adhesive agent) and/or the microspheres (first microspheres) contained in the contact adhesive layer (first contact adhesive layer) of the laminate. By using substances having chemical properties that are similar to those of the adhesive component contained in the first contact adhesive agent and the adhesive component contained in the second contact adhesive agent, i.e. both of the adhesive components in the first and second contact adhesive agents being chloroprene rubber or the both of the adhesive components being acrylic copolymers, even higher contact adhesion can be achieved.

(42) In some embodiments, the primer agent contains the second microspheres at an amount of approximately 2 parts by mass or greater, approximately 5 parts by mass or greater, or approximately 8 parts by mass or greater; but approximately 550 parts by mass or less, approximately 500 parts by mass or less, or approximately 450 parts by mass or less, per 100 parts

by mass of the second contact adhesive agent. In these embodiments, the plurality of protruding portions formed on the surface of the second contact adhesive layer of the installation surface via application of the primer agent reduces the initial contact area of a laminate brought into contact with the prime installation surface, and thus the laminate can be more easily slid and positioned on the adherend surface. Furthermore, while not wishing to be bound to any particular theory, in these embodiments, it is conceived that shear adhesion can be enhanced by making the microspheres contained in the contact adhesive layer of the laminate and the microspheres in the second contact adhesive layer formed on the surface of the installation surface to engage each other when the laminate is adhered to the installation surface via further pressing (as by an installer's hand or via rollers or the like). When the substrate layer of the laminate is flexible like a decorative film, dimensional stability of the laminate may be enhanced by suppressing the in-plane shrinkage of the substrate layer due to the engaging of the microspheres.

(43) Friction, and thus slideability, between the contact adhesive layer of the laminate and the primer agent is a function of the total amount of the microspheres contained in the adhesive layer and primer agent layers, respectively. In some embodiments, the total of the amount (part by mass) of the microspheres (first microspheres) per 100 parts by mass of the contact adhesive agent (first contact adhesive agent) contained in the contact adhesive layer of the laminate and the amount (part by mass) of the second microspheres per 100 parts by mass of the second contact adhesive agent of the primer agent is approximately 5 parts by mass or greater, approximately 7 parts by mass or greater, or approximately 9 parts by mass or greater; but approximately 1100 parts by mass or less, approximately 1000 parts by mass or less, or approximately 900 parts by mass or less.

(44) In yet another embodiment of the present disclosure, as shown in FIG. 2, a method of producing a laminated structure is shown. The method comprises the steps of preparing laminate **10**; applying the primer agent on a surface of an installation surface **30** so as to form a second contact adhesive layer **20**; and placing the laminate **10** on the second contact adhesive layer **20**. Using such method, the laminate **10** can slide because of the plurality of protruding portions **18** on the contact adhesive layer **14**, accordingly, the laminate **10** can be repositioned to an accurate position. As shown in FIG. 2, if the second contact adhesive layer **20** contains microspheres **24**, the laminate **10** can exhibit better slidability. When positioned properly by the installer, the contact adhesive layer **14** of the laminate **10** may be brought into more intimate contact with the second contact adhesive layer **20** by the installer applying pressure to successive portions of the laminate **10** onto the installation surface **30** so as to form a laminate structure shown in FIG. 3. Such pressure may be applied using techniques well known in the art, such as by pressing with a hand, roller, or the like.

(45) FIG. 4A and FIG. 4B show a method of installing floor materials such as flooring panels using an adhesive kit of the present disclosure. Flooring panels typically have a protrusion on a side surface, and at installation they are positioned to mate with the a recess on the side surface of an adjacent material. Flooring panels are often bonded to a carrier material such as particle board, mortar, or the like, which is arranged on a floor of a building, in a manner that the flooring panels mates with an adjacent flooring panels. A contact adhesive comprising a contact adhesive layer **116** having a plurality of protruding portion because of microspheres **118** can be formed on the substrate layer **116** of a flooring panel, and, meanwhile, a primer agent containing microspheres **124** can be applied on a surface of a floor **130** to form a second contact adhesive layer **122** on the floor **130** using an adhesive kit in this disclosure. The contact adhesive layer **116** of the flooring panel **110** can slide smoothly, allowing for easy repositioning. Once the panels are in proper position, their position may be fixed by pressing with a pressure tool **140**.

(46) The installation surface may be, for example, a surface of a piece of furniture, such as bookshelf, cupboard, or chest, an inner wall or floor of a building, an inner wall or outer wall of an automobile or a railway vehicle, a surface of a household item.

(47) The application of the primer agent onto the installation surface can be performed in the same

manner as for the application of the contact adhesive composition onto the substrate layer surface, as mentioned above. Examples include the use of knife coating, bar coating, blade coating, doctor coating, roll coating, cast coating, spraying, screen printing, stencil printing, brush coating, or the like. After the primer agent is applied to the installation surface, drying or curing may be performed as necessary. In embodiments where the primer agent contains the second organic resin microspheres, the application conditions of the primer agent, such as coating speed, application temperature, coating thickness (wet thickness), and drying or curing conditions including, for example, drying or curing temperature, can be selected in a manner that the protruding portions are formed with sufficient density on the second contact adhesive layer surface.

(48) When the laminate is placed on the installation surface in a manner that the surface of the contact adhesive layer of the laminate faces the surface of the second contact adhesive layer and laminated by pressing, the pressure applied to the laminate can be set to, for example, approximately 1 k Pa or greater, approximately 5 kPa or greater, or approximately 10 k Pa or greater; but approximately 1000 k Pa or less, approximately 600 k Pa or less, or approximately 200 k Pa or less. Positioning or repositioning of the laminate can be performed by sliding the laminate on the installation surface. The lamination is typically performed at approximately 10° C. or higher, or approximately 20° C. or higher; but approximately 100° C. or lower, or approximately 50° C. or lower or approximately 1 second or longer, or approximately 3 seconds or longer; but approximately 60 mins or shorter, or approximately 30 mins or shorter. As described above, an installed structure having the substrate layer, the first contact adhesive layer (contact adhesive layer of the laminate), the second contact adhesive layer (applied to the installation surface), and then the installation surface, in this order, can be formed. When the first contact adhesive layer and the second contact adhesive layer have identical chemical composition, the interface between these adhesive layers, after the two layers are pressed together, may not be easily observed.

(49) The laminate, the adhesive kit, and the contact adhesive composition of the present disclosure can be widely used for industrial purposes such as for interior and exterior of automobiles, railway vehicles, and the like, general household utensils, such as envelopes, as well as for housing and building purposes, including applications of a decorative sheet or decorative plate to furniture, such as bookshelf, cupboard, or chest, or to an inner wall of a building, installing interior building materials, such as flooring materials, on a floor of a building, or the like. Furthermore, use of protective liners processing paper, processing film, or the like during the production of a decorative sheet can be omitted, in some embodiments, by using the laminate of the present disclosure.

EXAMPLES

(50) In the following working examples, specific embodiments of the present disclosure are exemplified, but the present invention is not restricted thereto. All parts and percentages are by mass unless otherwise indicated.

(51) Materials used in the present working examples are shown in Table 1.

(52) TABLE-US-00001 TABLE 1 Solid Tg Molecular content Product name or composition (° C.)
Weight Solvent (mass %) Adhesive WG 22, chloroprene rubber-based -28.sup.1) — Water 55
agent 1 (A1) contact adhesive agent (Konishi Co., Ltd., Osaka-shi, Osaka, Japan) Adhesive Bond 7,
acrylic contact adhesive 22.sup.1) — Water 53 agent 2 (A2) agent (3M Japan Limited, Shinagawa-
ku, Tokyo, Japan) Adhesive n-Butyl acrylate (BA) - acrylic acid -48.sup.2) 560,000 Ethyl 33 agent
3 (A3) (AA) = 94:6, adhesive acrylic acetate polymer Adhesive JA7562, acrylic pressure-sensitive
— Water 65 agent 4 (A4) adhesive (3M Japan Limited, Shinagawa-ku, Tokyo, Japan) Acrylic
Chemisnow (trademark) MZ-20HN, — — — 100 microspheres nontacky solid microspheres, 1
(B1) volume average particle size Dv 20 µm, crosslinked acrylic polymer (Soken Chemical &
Engineering Co., Ltd., Toshima-ku, Tokyo, Japan) Acrylic Chemisnow (trademark) MX- — — —
100 microspheres 80H3wT, nontacky solid 2 (B2) microspheres, volume average particle size Dv
0.8 µm, crosslinked acrylic polymer (Soken Chemical & Engineering Co., Ltd., Toshima-ku,
Tokyo, Japan) Acrylic Chemisnow (trademark) MX-500H, — — — 100 microspheres nontacky

solid microspheres, 3 (B3) volume average particle size D_v 5 μm , crosslinked acrylic polymer (Soken Chemical & Engineering Co., Ltd., Toshima-ku, Tokyo, Japan) Acrylic Chemisnow (trademark) MZ-10HN, — — — 100 microspheres nontacky solid microspheres, 4 (B4) volume average particle size D_v 10 μm , crosslinked acrylic polymer (Soken Chemical & Engineering Co., Ltd., Toshima-ku, Tokyo, Japan) Acrylic Chemisnow (trademark) MZ-30H, — — — 100 microspheres nontacky solid microspheres, 5 (B5) volume average particle size D_v 30 μm , crosslinked acrylic polymer (Soken Chemical & Engineering Co., Ltd., Toshima-ku, Tokyo, Japan) Urethane Art-pearl (trademark) C-400, -13.sup.3) — — 100 microspheres nontacky solid elastic 6 (B6) microspheres, volume average particle size D_v 14 μm , crosslinked urethane polymer (Negami Chemical Industrial Co., Ltd., Nomi, Ishikawa, Japan) Urethane Art-pearl (trademark) P400T, -34.sup.3) — — 100 microspheres nontacky solid elastic 7 (B7) microspheres, volume average particle size D_v 16 μm , crosslinked urethane polymer (Negami Chemical Industrial Co., Ltd., Nomi, Ishikawa, Japan) Urethane Art-pearl (trademark) JB400T, -52.sup.3) — — 100 microspheres nontacky solid elastic 8 (B8) microspheres, volume average particle size D_v 17 μm , crosslinked urethane polymer (Negami Chemical Industrial Co., Ltd., Nomi, Ishikawa, Japan) Acrylic Art-pearl (trademark) GR200, — — — 100 microspheres nontacky solid elastic 9 (B9) microspheres, volume average particle size D_v 32 μm , crosslinked acrylic polymer (Negami Chemical Industrial Co., Ltd., Nomi, Ishikawa, Japan) Acrylic Tacky solid microspheres, volume -49.sup.2) — Water 100 microspheres average particle size D_v 29 μm , 10 (B10) crosslinked acrylic polymer (3M Japan Ltd. Shinagawa, Tokyo, Japan) Primer 1 (P1) A mixed solution of A1 and B1, — — Water — A1:B1 = 100:10 (solid content ratio) Primer 2 (P2) A mixed solution of A2 and B1, — — Water — A2:B1 = 100:10 (solid content ratio) Primer 3 (P3) DI-NOC (registered trademark) — — Ethyl — primer DP900N3 (3M Japan acetate Limited, Shinagawa-ku, Tokyo, Japan) Primer 4 (P4) A mixed solution of A2 and B1, — — Water — A2:B1 = 100:30 (solid content ratio) Primer 5 (P5) A mixed solution of A1 and B10, — — Water — A1:B10 = 100:30 (solid content ratio) Crosslinking Epoxy-based crosslinking agent E- — — Toluene 5 agent (CL1) AX (Soken Chemical & Engineering Co., Ltd., Toshima-ku, Tokyo, Japan) .sup.1) Calculated from $\tan\delta$ of dynamic viscoelasticity measurement .sup.2) Calculated by Fox equation .sup.3) Value provided by manufacturer's catalog

(53) The glass transition temperatures (T_g) of the adhesive agent 1 (A1) and the adhesive agent 2 (A2) were measured using an ARES dynamic viscoelasticity measuring device (manufactured by TA Instruments Japan Inc., Shinagawa-ku, Tokyo, Japan). A1 or A2 was formed into a film having a dry thickness of 3 mm, and test samples having a diameter of about 7.9 mm were produced by punching out the film. A peak temperature of loss factor $\tan \delta$ (=shear loss elastic modulus G'' /shear storage elastic modulus G') obtained by measuring the shear storage elastic modulus G' and the shear loss elastic modulus G'' in shear mode at a frequency of 1.0 Hz, while the temperature was raised at a rate of temperature increase of 5.0° C./min from -20° C. to 150° C., was used as the glass transition temperature.

(54) The adhesive agent 3 (A3) was prepared by the following procedure. A3 was prepared as an ethyl acetate solution (solid content: 33%) by dissolving 94 parts by mass of n-butyl acrylate (BA) and 6 parts by mass of acrylic acid (AA) in 200 parts by mass of ethyl acetate, adding 0.2 parts by mass of 2,2'-azobis(2,4-dimethylvaleronitrile) (trade name: V-65, manufactured by Wako Pure Chemical Industries, Ltd., Osaka-shi, Osaka, Japan) as a polymerization initiator, and then reacting the mixture for 24 hours at 65° C. in a nitrogen atmosphere. The weight average molecular weight (M_w) of A3 was 560,000, and the glass transition temperature (T_g) was -48° C. The T_g was determined by the Fox equation (below equation) assuming that each polymer is formed by copolymerization of n types of monomers.

(55)

$$1/T_g = X_1/(T_{g_1} + 273.15) + X_2/(T_{g_2} + 273.15) + \dots + X_n/(T_{g_n} + 273.15) \quad \text{Equation 2}$$

(Tg.sub.1: Glass transition temperature of homopolymer of component 1, Tg.sub.2: Glass transition temperature of homopolymer of component 2, Tg.sub.n: Glass transition temperature of homopolymer of component n, X.sub.1: Mass fraction of component 1 monomer that is added during polymerization, X.sub.2: Mass fraction of component 2 monomer that is added during polymerization, X.sub.n: Mass fraction of component n monomer that is added during polymerization,

$X_{sub.1} + X_{sub.2} + \dots + X_{sub.n} = 1$)

Evaluation Method

1. Blocking Resistance A

(56) The test piece was cut into a length of 300 mm and a width of 210 mm. The test piece had no release liner. The test piece was wound around a 6-inch core and left at 23° C. for 48 hours. When the test piece did not adhere to the embossed surface of the film and was easily peeled off, the test piece was evaluated as being “excellent”. When the test piece was slightly adhered to the embossed surface of the film but was peeled off, the test piece was evaluated as being “good”. When the test piece was firmly adhered to the embossed surface of the film but was peeled off without extending the film, the test piece was evaluated as being “fair”. When the test piece was firmly adhered to the embossed surface of the film and separation of these was difficult, the test piece was evaluated as being “poor”.

(57) 2. Blocking Resistance B

(58) Two test pieces were prepared. The adhesive layer face of the first test piece was lightly placed on the top of the face on which no adhesive agent was coated of the second test piece, at 23° C. When the first test piece did not adhere to the surface of the second test piece and was easily peeled off, the case was evaluated as being “excellent”. When the first test piece was slightly adhered to the surface of the second test piece but was peeled off, the case was evaluated as being “good”. When the first test piece was firmly adhered to the surface of the second test piece and separation of these was difficult, the case was evaluated as being “poor”.

(59) 3. Slidability A

(60) The test piece was cut into a length of 150 mm and a width of 25 mm. The adhesive layer face of the test piece was lightly brought into contact with the primer-treated face of plasterboard at 25° C. When the test piece did not adhere to the plasterboard surface and was easily slid, the test piece was evaluated as being “excellent”. When the test piece was capable of sliding on the plasterboard surface, the test piece was evaluated as being “good”. When the test piece was firmly adhered to the plasterboard surface and thus sliding was difficult, the test piece was evaluated as being “poor”.

(61) 4. Slidability B

(62) Two test pieces were prepared. The adhesive layer face of the first test piece was placed on the top of the adhesive layer face of the second test piece without applying pressure at 23° C. When the first test piece was easily slid on the surface of the second test piece, the case was evaluated as “good”. When the first test piece was firmly adhered to the surface of the second test piece and thus sliding was difficult, the case was evaluated as being “poor”.

(63) 5. Adhesive Force

(64) The test piece was cut into a length of 150 mm and a width of 25 mm. The adhesive layer face of the test piece was pressure-adhered to the primer-treated face of plasterboard at 23° C. using a squeegee, and then left at 23° C. for 48 hours. The adhesive force was measured in accordance with JIS Z 0237 8.2.3. Using a tensile testing machine (Tensilon universal testing machine, model: RTC-1210A, manufactured by A & D Company, Limited, Toshima-ku, Tokyo, Japan), 180° peel strength was measured at a peeling rate of 300 mm/min at 20° C. For all the test pieces, peeling mode was for surface breakage of the plasterboard, and the peak value of the adhesive force was recorded as the representative value.

(65) 6. Adhesive Property

(66) Two test pieces were prepared. The adhesive layer face of the first test piece was placed on the

top of the adhesive layer face of the second test piece and pressure-adhered using a squeegee in an environment at 23° C. The test pieces were left for 5 minutes in an environment at 23° C. When the test pieces were firmly adhered, the case was evaluated as being “good”. When the test pieces were easily peeled, the case was evaluated as being “poor”.

(67) 7. 60 Degree Gloss Value

(68) The 60 Degree gloss values of contact adhesive layer were measured by portable gloss meter GMX-202 (Manufactured by Murakami Color Research Laboratory (Chuo-ku, Tokyo, Japan). The values were measured at three positions. Averaged value was calculated.

Example 1

(69) A contact adhesive composition was prepared by mixing the adhesive agent 1 (A1) and the acrylic microspheres 1 (B1). The mass ratio of A1 and B1 was 100:10 in terms of solid content. The contact adhesive composition was coated on a smooth surface of an embossed polyvinyl chloride (PVC) film having a thickness of about 170 μm using a knife coater and dried for 4 minutes at 40° C. After the drying, a contact adhesive layer having a thickness of 16 μm was obtained. The contact adhesive layer had recesses and protrusions on the surface. The coated amount of the contact adhesive layer was 23 g/m.^{sup.2}. The surface of the contact adhesive layer was substantially nontackey and it is unnecessary to cover the surface by a release liner. As the primer layer (second contact adhesive layer), the primer 1 (P1) was coated on a plasterboard using a brush. The primer layer was dried for 1 hour at 23° C. After the drying, the coated amount of the primer layer was 35 g/m.^{sup.2}. The PVC film having the contact adhesive layer was pressure-adhered to the primer layer of the plasterboard using a squeegee at 23° C. The evaluation results are also shown is Table 2.

Examples 2 to 51

(70) The test piece of Example 2 to 51 were produced in the same manner as in Example 1. However, each formulation of adhesive and microspheres for the adhesive layer and primer condition, and manufacturing conditions are shown is Table 2. The evaluation results are also shown is Table 2.

Comparative Example 1

(71) A pressure-sensitive adhesive composition was prepared by mixing the adhesive agent 3 (A3) and the crosslinking agent 1 (CL1). The mass ratio of A3 and CL1 was 100:0.1 in terms of solid content. The pressure-sensitive adhesive composition was coated on a smooth surface of an embossed polyvinyl chloride (PVC) film having a thickness of 170 μm using a knife coater and dried for 5 minutes at 95° C. After the drying, a pressure-sensitive adhesive layer having a thickness of 38 μm was obtained. The coated amount of the pressure-sensitive adhesive layer was 46 g/m.^{sup.2}. As the pressure-sensitive adhesive layer has high tackiness at room temperature, it was necessary to cover the surface of the adhesive layer by a release liner. Furthermore, as the primer layer, the primer 3 (P3) was coated on a plasterboard using a brush. The primer layer was dried for 1 hour at 23° C. The PVC film having the pressure-sensitive adhesive layer was pressure-adhered to the primer layer of the plasterboard using a squeegee at 23° C. The evaluation results are shown is Table 3.

Comparative Examples 2 to 14

(72) The test piece of Comparative Examples 2 to 14 were produced in the same manner as in Example 1. However, each formulation of adhesive and microspheres for the adhesive layer and primer condition, and manufacturing conditions are shown is Table 3. The evaluation results are also shown is Table 3.

(73) TABLE-US-00002 Microspheres Adhesive layer Adhesive Adhesive agent Part Coated 60 Blocking force Part by by Thickness amount Release Degree resistance Slidability (N/25 Type mass Type mass (μm) (g/m.^{sup.2}) liner gloss Primer A A mm) Example 1 A1 100 B1 10 16 23 None .sup.2) 22 P1 Excellent Good 30 Example 2 A1 100 B1 10 20 30 None 20 P1 Excellent Good 30 Example 3 A1 100 B1 30 19 27 None 11 P1 Excellent Excellent 33 Example 4 A1 100 B1 30 23

33 None 9 P1 Excellent Excellent 31 Example 5 A1 100 B1 10 16 23 None 22 A1 Excellent Good
 33 Example 6 A1 100 B1 10 20 30 None 20 A1 Excellent Good 32 Example 7 A1 100 B1 30 19 27
 None 11 A1 Excellent Good 32 Example 8 A1 100 B1 30 23 33 None 9 A1 Excellent Good 29
 Example 9 A2 100 B1 10 20 25 None 30 P2 Excellent Good 32 Example 10 A2 100 B1 10 23 35
 None 23 P2 Excellent Good 30 Example 11 A2 100 B1 10 20 25 None 30 A2 Excellent Good 40
 Example 12 A2 100 B1 10 23 35 None 23 A2 Excellent Good 25 Example 13 A2 100 B2 30 12 24
 None 28 P4 Good Excellent 29 Example 14 A2 100 B3 30 13 19 None 13 P4 Good Excellent 30
 Example 15 A2 100 B4 30 15 25 None 11 P4 Good Excellent 36 Example 16 A2 100 B5 30 22 19
 None 11 P4 Excellent Excellent 39 Example 17 A2 100 B2 30 25 32 None 28 P4 Good Excellent
 36 Example 18 A2 100 B3 30 20 29 None 16 P4 Good Excellent 37 Example 19 A2 100 B4 30 19
 29 None 14 P4 Good Excellent 30 Example 20 A2 100 B5 30 24 28 None 8 P4 Excellent Excellent
 30 Example 21 A2 100 B2 30 12 24 None 28 A2 Good Good 42 Example 22 A2 100 B3 30 13 19
 None 13 A2 Good Good 30 Example 23 A2 100 B4 30 15 25 None 11 A2 Good Good 46 Example
 24 A2 100 B5 30 22 19 None 11 A2 Excellent Good 34 Example 25 A2 100 B2 30 25 32 None 28
 A2 Good Good 34 Example 26 A2 100 B3 30 20 29 None 16 A2 Good Good 40 Example 27 A2
 100 B4 30 19 25 None 14 A2 Good Good 46 Example 28 A2 100 B5 30 24 19 None 8 A2
 Excellent Good 32 Example 29 A2 100 B1 50 23 24 None 6 P4 Excellent Excellent 27 Example 30
 A2 100 B1 100 26 27 None 4 P4 Excellent Excellent 22 Example 31 A2 100 B1 50 25 28 None 6
 P4 Excellent Excellent 37 Example 32 A2 100 B1 100 30 34 None 4 P4 Excellent Excellent 27
 Example 33 A2 100 B1 50 23 24 None 6 A2 Excellent Excellent 32 Example 34 A2 100 B1 100 26
 27 None 4 A2 Excellent Excellent 17 Example 35 A2 100 B1 50 25 28 None 6 A2 Excellent
 Excellent 32 Example 36 A2 100 B1 100 30 34 None 4 A2 Excellent Excellent 16 Example 37 A2
 100 B6 30 14 21 None 7 P4 Good Excellent 12 Example 38 A2 100 B7 30 16 23 None 8 P4 Fair
 Excellent 10 Example 39 A2 100 B8 30 11 19 None 7 P4 Fair Excellent 10 Example 40 A2 100 B6
 30 19 25 None 8 P4 Good Excellent 11 Example 41 A2 100 B7 30 20 28 None 8 P4 Fair Excellent
 10 Example 42 A2 100 B8 30 18 26 None 8 P4 Fair Good 10 Example 43 A2 100 B9 30 35 32
 None 11 P4 Excellent Excellent 12 Example 44 A2 100 B6 30 14 21 None 7 A2 Good Good 11
 Example 45 A2 100 B7 30 16 23 None 8 A2 Fair Good 11 Example 46 A2 100 B9 30 35 32 None
 11 A2 Excellent Excellent 13 Example 47 A1 100 B10 30 16 19 None 15 P5 Good Good 33
 Example 48 A1 100 B10 30 18 21 None 14 P5 Good Good 34 Example 49 A1 100 B10 200 11 13
 None 6 P5 Good Good 17 Example 50 A1 100 B10 400 9 8 None 5 P5 Good Good 15 Example
 51 A1 100 B1 200 19 16 None 3 P5 Excellent Excellent 7

(74) TABLE-US-00003 TABLE 3 Microspheres Adhesive layer Adhesive Adhesive agent Part
 Coated 60 force Part by by Thickness amount Release Degree Blocking (N/25 Type mass Type
 mass (μm) (g/m.sup.2) liner gloss Primer resistance A Slidability A mm) Comparative A3 100 None
 0 38 46 Yes *) 47 P3 Poor Poor 33 Example 1 Comparative A1 100 None 0 7 18 None 31 P1 Poor
 Good 27 Example 2 Comparative A1 100 None 0 15 26 None 34 P1 Poor Good 32 Example 3
 Comparative A1 100 None 0 7 18 None 31 A1 Good Poor 32 Example 4 Comparative A1 100
 None 0 15 26 None 34 A1 Good Poor 29 Example 5 Comparative A3 100 None 0 38 46 Yes 47 P3
 Excellent Poor 33 Example 6 Comparative A2 100 B1 50 23 24 None 6 None Excellent Excellent
 0 Example 7 Comparative A2 100 B1 100 26 27 None 4 None Excellent Excellent 0 Example 8
 Comparative A2 100 B2 30 12 24 None 28 None Good Excellent 0 Example 9 Comparative A2
 100 B3 30 13 19 None 13 None Good Excellent 0 Example 10 Comparative A2 100 B4 30 15 25
 None 11 None Good Excellent 0 Example 11 Comparative A2 100 B5 30 22 19 None 11 None
 Excellent Excellent 0 Example 12 Comparative A2 100 None 0 13 20 None 52 P4 Poor Excellent
 10 Example 13 Comparative A2 100 None 0 13 20 None 52 A2 Poor Poor 10 Example 14
 Example 2-1

(75) A contact adhesive composition was prepared by mixing the adhesive agent 1 (A1) and the
 acrylic microspheres 1 (B1). The mass ratio of A1 and B1 was 100:30 in terms of solid content.
 The contact adhesive composition was coated on one face of a plywood board (150 mm×70 mm×1

mm thickness) using a brush, and dried at 23° C. for 60 minutes. After the drying, the contact adhesive layer had recesses and protrusions on the surface. The coated amount of the contact adhesive layer was approximately 35 g/m². The evaluation results are shown in Table 4.

Example 2-2

(76) The test piece of Example 2-2 was produced in the same manner as in Example 2-1 except for changing the adhesive agent to the adhesive agent 2 (A2).

Comparative Example 2-1 to 2-3

(77) The test piece of Comparative Example 2-1 to 2-3 were produced in the same manner.

However, each condition of the material compositions and evaluation results are shown in Table 4.

(78) TABLE-US-00004 TABLE 4 Adhesive agent Microspheres Part Part Blocking Slid- by by resistance ability Adhesive Type mass Type mass B B property Example 2-1 A1 100 B1 30

Excellent Good Good Example 2-2 A2 100 B1 30 Excellent Good Good Comparative A1 100 None

0 Poor Poor Good Example 2-1 Comparative A2 100 None 0 Poor Poor Good Example 2-2

Comparative A4 100 B1 30 Good Poor Good Example 2-3

REFERENCE SIGNS LIST

(79) **10** Laminate **12** Substrate layer **14** Contact adhesive layer **16** Contact adhesive agent **18** microsphere **20** Second contact adhesive layer **22** Second contact adhesive agent **24** Second organic resin microsphere **30** Adherend

Claims

1. An adhesive kit comprising: a laminate configured to be adhered on a second contact adhesive layer covering an installation surface, the laminate comprising: a substrate layer having a first major surface and a second major surface, and a contact adhesive layer having a first major surface and a second major surface, the second major surface of the contact adhesive layer adhesively coupled to the first major surface of the substrate layer, the contact adhesive layer comprising a contact adhesive agent and microspheres having an average particle size of 0.5 μm or greater, the contact adhesive agent comprising at least one of chloroprene rubber or acrylic copolymers, the contact adhesive layer comprising from 5 parts by mass to 500 parts by mass of the microspheres per 100 parts by mass of the contact adhesive agent, the first major surface of the contact adhesive layer comprising a plurality of protrusions corresponding to the locations of at least some of the microspheres; and a primer agent comprising a second contact adhesive agent comprising at least one of chloroprene rubber or acrylic copolymers, and the primer agent comprising second microspheres having an average particle size of 0.5 μm or greater, the second microspheres comprising a crosslinked resin and are nontacky, solid microspheres of acrylic polymer or urethane polymer.

2. The adhesive kit of claim 1, wherein the contact adhesive layer is nontacky.

3. The adhesive kit of claim 1, wherein the microspheres are nontacky.

4. The adhesive kit of claim 1, wherein the microspheres are solid microspheres of acrylic polymer.

5. The adhesive kit of claim 1, wherein the second microspheres are solid microspheres of acrylic polymer.

6. The adhesive kit of claim 1, wherein a mass per unit area of the contact adhesive layer is from 5 g/m² to 100 g/m².

7. The adhesive kit of claim 1, wherein a 60 degree gloss value of the first major surface of the contact adhesive layer is from 1 to 40.

8. The adhesive kit of claim 1, wherein the contact adhesive agent comprises acrylic copolymer having a glass transition temperature from 0° C. to 60° C.

9. The adhesive kit of claim 1, wherein the primer agent comprises from 5 parts by mass to 500 parts by mass of the second microspheres per 100 parts by mass of the second contact adhesive agent.

10. A laminated structure formed on an installation surface to be adhered wherein the laminated structure is formed using the adhesive kit of claim 1 and wherein the laminated structure comprises: the laminate, and a second contact adhesive layer formed by the primer agent covered on the installation surface, wherein both of the contact adhesive layer of the laminate and the second contact adhesive layer are adhered each other.
11. The laminated structure of claim 10, wherein the second contact adhesive layer comprises a plurality of protrusions corresponding to locations of at least some of the second microspheres.
12. The laminated structure of claim 10, wherein the second contact adhesive layer comprises from 5 parts by mass to 500 parts by mass of the second microspheres per 100 parts by mass of the second contact adhesive agent.
13. The laminated structure of claim 10, wherein the microspheres are solid microspheres of acrylic polymer.
14. The laminated structure of claim 10, wherein the second microspheres are solid microspheres of acrylic polymer.
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